CFLMUN'26

Strengthening the Protection and Reception of Refugees Worldwide

Gökçe Altay \ Damla Koçyıldız

STUDY GUIDE

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1. LETTER FROM THE SECRETARY GENERAL

Dear Delegates,

Welcome to CFLMUN'26 everyone! My name is Sümeyra, and I have the honour of serving as the Secretary General at this conference. I'm full of excitement and happiness. Also, I'd like to thank my Head of Academy Belinay Takcı, my Under Secretary Genereal Gökçe Altay and my Academic Assistant Damla Koçyıldız for helping to organize the committee.

In the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees, UNHCR, you will be able to talk and discuss the refugee problem that emerged as a result of war, which is one of the biggest problems of today.

Also, I want to say thank you to each and every one of you for choosing to be a part of this committee. Your presence and participation are what will make it truly meaningful. I look forward to seeing you all between May 1st and 3rd, ready to challenge perspectives, defend positions, and most importantly, enjoy the experience.

Wishing you all the best of luck. Let's shape the future in the light of diplomacy!

Warm regards,

Sümeyra Gülsüm Çolak

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2. LETTER FROM THE HEAD OF ACADEMY

Distinguished delegates,

It is a great honour to welcome you to the first edition of CFLMUN. Over the course of this conference, you will engage in thoughtful debate, share perspectives, and develop solutions to complex global issues. In a world shaped by conflict and uncertainty, your voice carries weight. The responsibility to think critically and act thoughtfully belongs to you. As delegates, you are not only participants in debate, but contributors to ideas that shape perspectives beyond this room.

Your dedication to preparing for this conference already shows your commitment to building a better future. Use this opportunity to challenge your critical thinking, refine your voice, and explore perspectives different from your own. We look forward to seeing the creativity, determination, and insight you bring to your committees.

It's essential not to forget that the experience you acquire here will stay with you for years to come. Make the most of every moment, both inside and outside your committee sessions. Do not hesitate to seek guidance whenever you need it.

Your seat is ready. We are eager to hear your ideas.

Sincerely,

Belinay Takcı

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belinaytakci@gmail.com

3. LETTER FROM THE ACADEMIC ASSISTANT OF UNHCR

I believe UNHCR is one of the greatest committees to learn about MUN. It is also a really good opportunity to learn new things. So, we expect you to come here prepared to learn. We organized this MUN conference so that people who get excited about learning new things can have a great opportunity to develop their understanding of international matters, improve their research and public speaking skills and engage in productive discussions with other delegates.We encourage you to participate actively, share your perspectives, and collaborate with others to find solutions to the challenges that will be discussed in the committee. Your contribution will not only enrich the debates but also help you gain valuable experience in diplomacy and critical thinking.

We're looking forward to welcoming you and we hope that this conference will be both educational and inspiring for everyone involved.

Sincerely,

Damla Koçyıldız

4. INTRODUCTION TO THE COMMITTEE

a. What is UNHCR?

The Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees was established on the 14th of December 1950 by the United Nations General Assembly. The agency is mandated to lead and coordinate international action to protect refugees and resolve refugee problems worldwide. Its primary purpose is to safeguard the rights and well-being of refugees. It ensures that everyone can exercise the right to seek asylum and find safe refuge in another state, with the option to return home voluntarily, integrate locally or resettle in a third country.

Over five decades, the agency has helped an estimated 50 million people restart their lives. UNHCR now has more than 16803 personnel and works in a total of 134 countries to help 70.8 million people.

b. Roles and Functions of UNHCR

The UNHCR (also known as the UN Refugee Agency) has its headquarters in Geneva, but about 89 percent of its staff are in the field. Today, the staff provides protection and assistance to millions of refugees, returnees, internally displaced people and stateless persons.

The largest portion of UNHCR staff is based in countries in Asia and Africa, the continents that both host and generate the most refugees and internally displaced people. Many are in isolated locations, where staff works in difficult and often dangerous conditions.

UNHCR provides life saving assistance, including shelter, food, water and medical care to people, who are forced to flee conflict and persecution, many of whom have nobody left to turn to. Governments normally guarantee the basic human rights and security of their citizens, but when people are forced to flee and become refugees, they can no longer rely on this safety net.

UNHCR works to protect refugees, displaced and stateless people by advocating for their rights. It works with governments and partners to advise on and strengthen laws and national systems and to help provide services. Through this work, UNHCR helps ensure displaced people can access documentation, education, work and health care, and also works to ensure that stateless people achieve their right to a nationality. Bringing about positive changes at national, regional, and global levels can take years, but UNHCR accomplishes it with the help of lawyers, judges, civil society organizations, politicians and students.

5. Introduction to the Agenda Item

a. Key Terms and Concepts

● Key Terms

Refugee: Refugees are people who are outside their country of origin because of fear of persecution, conflict, violence or other situations that seriously disrupt public order. As a result, they require international protection. The 1951 Convention related to the Status of Refugees, together with regional instruments and the statute of UNHCR, provides the legal definition of a refugee.

Migrants: According to the UN, a migrant is any person who has lived in a foreign country for more than one year, regardless of whether the movement was voluntary or forced, and regardless of the legal status of the migration. In some cases, short term migrants, such as seasonal agricultural workers, are also included in this definition.

Asylum Seeker: An asylum seeker, like a refugee, is a person who seeks protection due to threats or dangers in their country of origin. While all refugees were once asylum seekers, not all asylum seekers are officially recognized as refugees. Refugee status is granted through a legal process after an asylum seeker applies for protection in a host country.

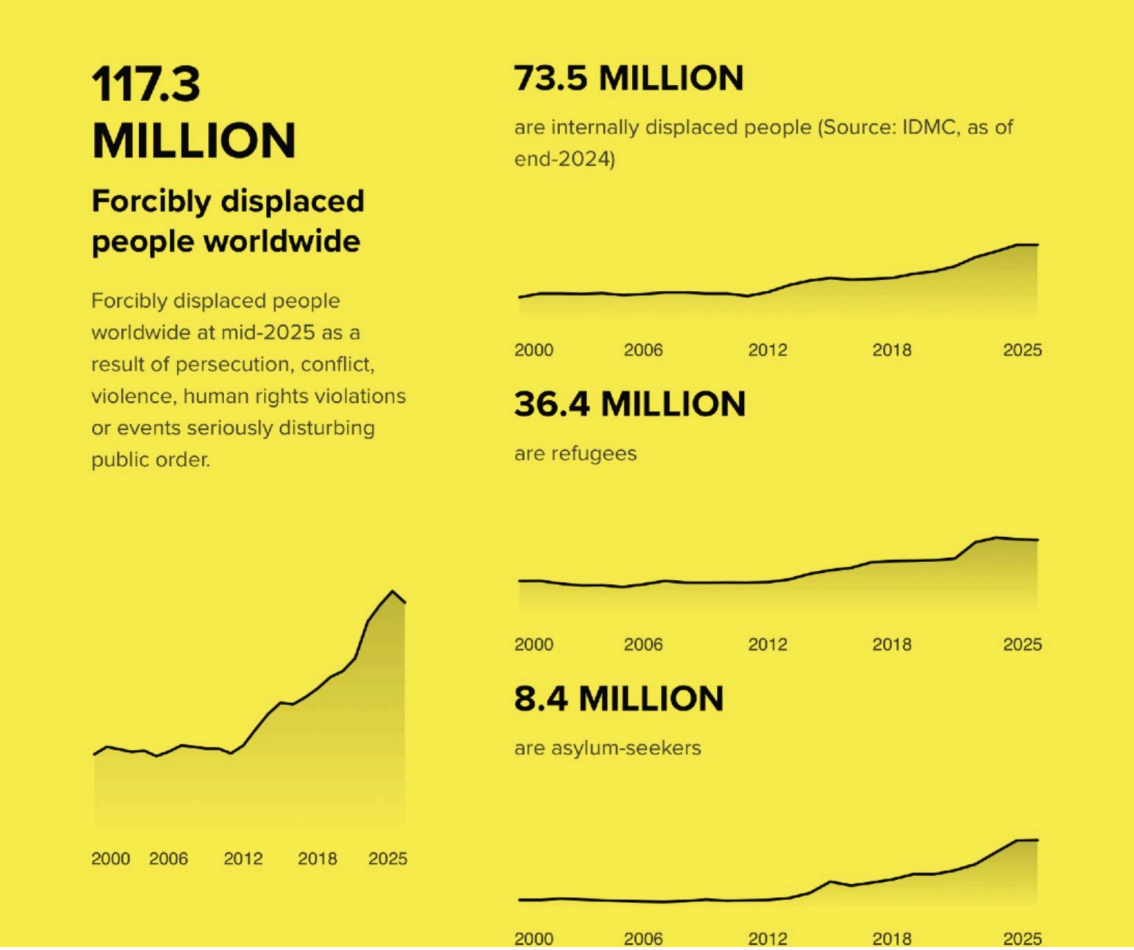
● Concepts

Non-Refoulement: A principle of international law that prevents states from sending refugees or asylum seekers back to places where they may face persecution or serious danger.

Resettlement Program: The process of moving refugees from the country, where they first asked for asylum to another country that agrees to accept them permanently.

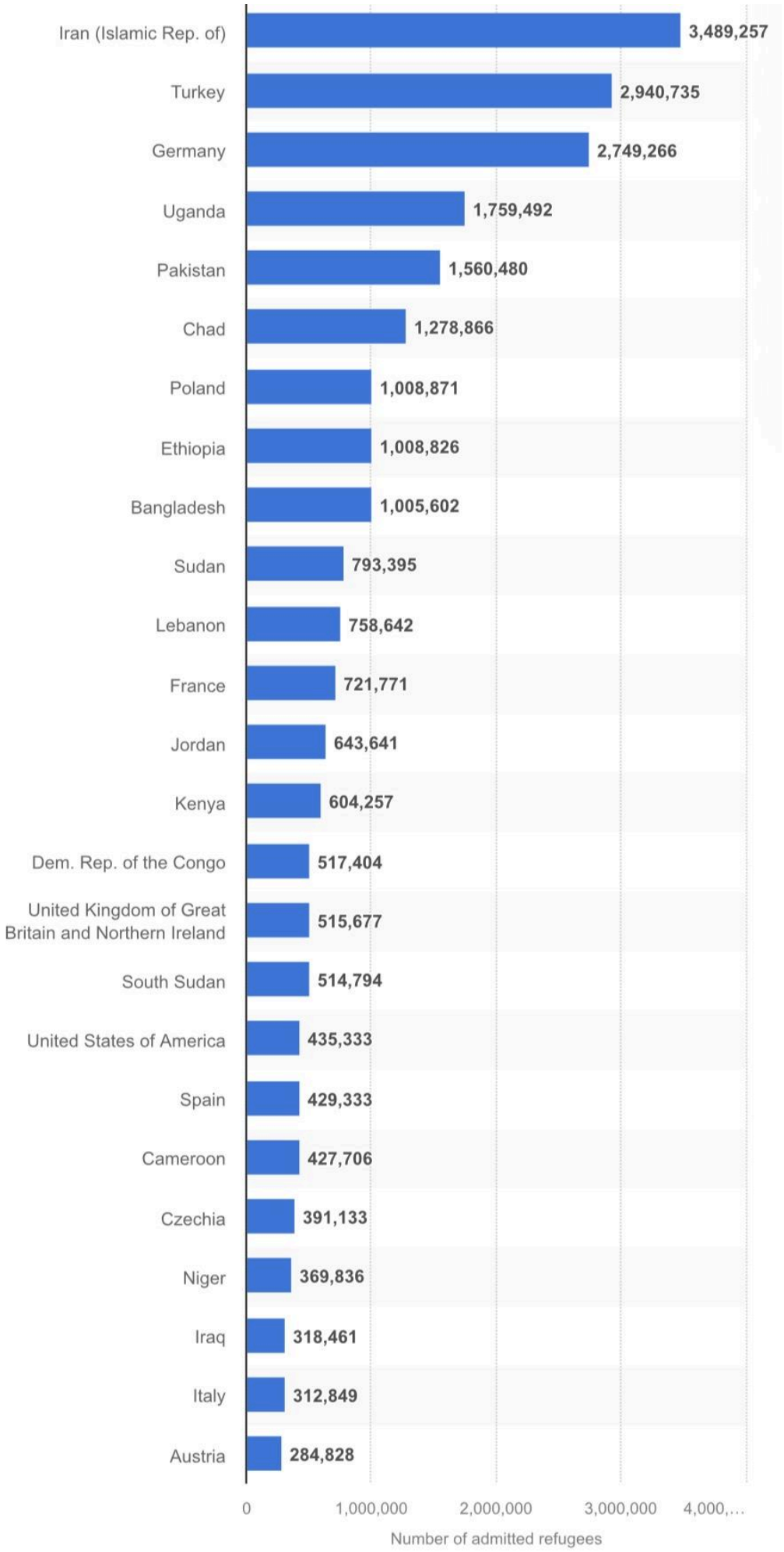
International Protection: The protection offered by the international community to individuals whose own states are unable or unwilling to protect them.

Forced migration: Forced migration is the involuntary or coerced movement of people away from their homes, driven by factors beyond their control such as armed conflict, persecution, natural disasters, famine, or development projects. It includes refugees, internally displaced persons (IDPs), and development-displaced individuals. Common causes include conflict, climate-related disasters, and human rights violations.



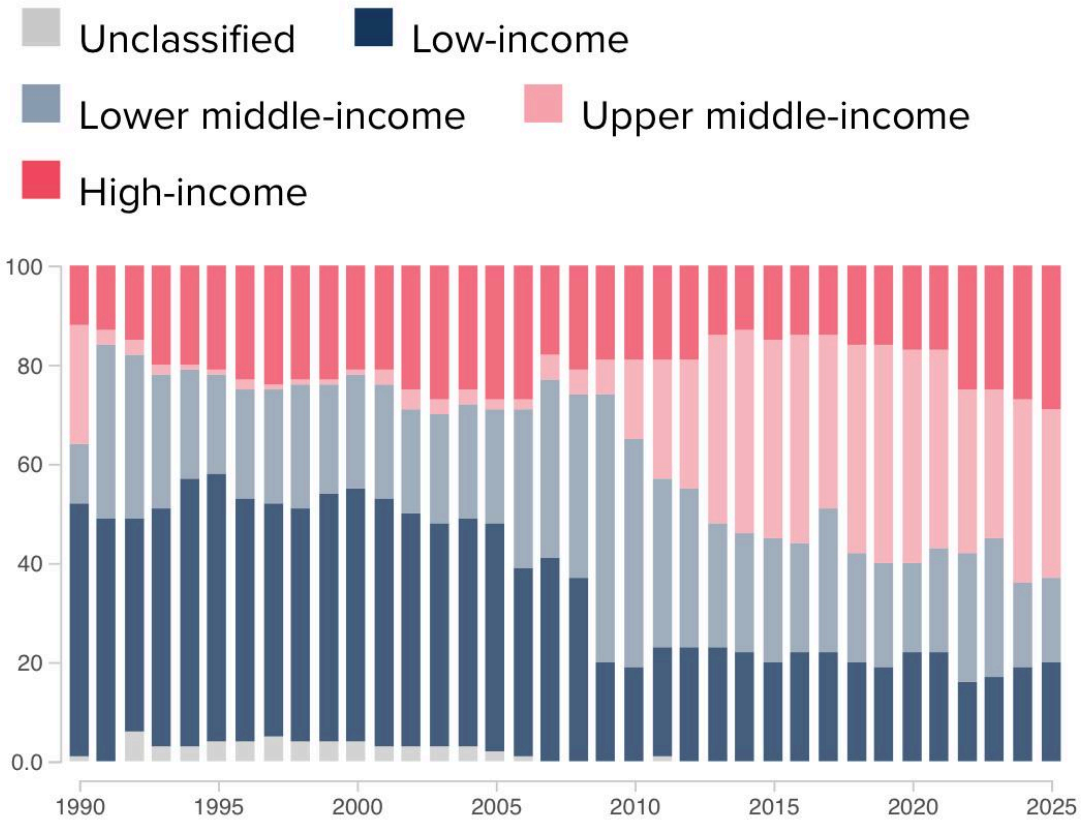
b. Historical Background

The international refugee protection system was developed after World War II, leading to the creation of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) in 1950 and the 1951 Refugee Convention with its 1967 Protocol, which defined the refugee status and state responsibilities under international law. Over the decades, major conflicts in regions such as Africa, Asia and Europe led to successive waves of displacement, demonstrating the need for international cooperation and legal protection mechanisms. By the end of 2024, the global number of forcibly displaced people had nearly doubled compared to a decade ago, highlighting the persistence and growth of refugee crises over time. These historical developments were the foundation of todays global response frameworks and shaped how states and organizations address forced displacement.


Iran (Islamic Rep. of)
3,489,257
Turkey
2,940,735
Germany
2,749,266
Uganda
1,759,492
Pakistan
1,560,480
Chad
1,278,866
Poland
1,008,871
Ethiopia
1,008,826
Bangladesh
1,005,602
Sudan
793,395
Lebanon
758,642
France
721,771
Jordan
643,641
Kenya
604,257
Dem. Rep. of the Congo
517,404
United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
515,677
South Sudan
514,794
United States of America
435,333
Spain
429,333
Cameroon
427,706
Czechia
391,133
Niger
369,836
Iraq
318,461
Italy
312,849
Austria
284,828
0
1,000,000
2,000,000
3,000,000
4,000,...
Number of admitted refugees

c. Current Situation

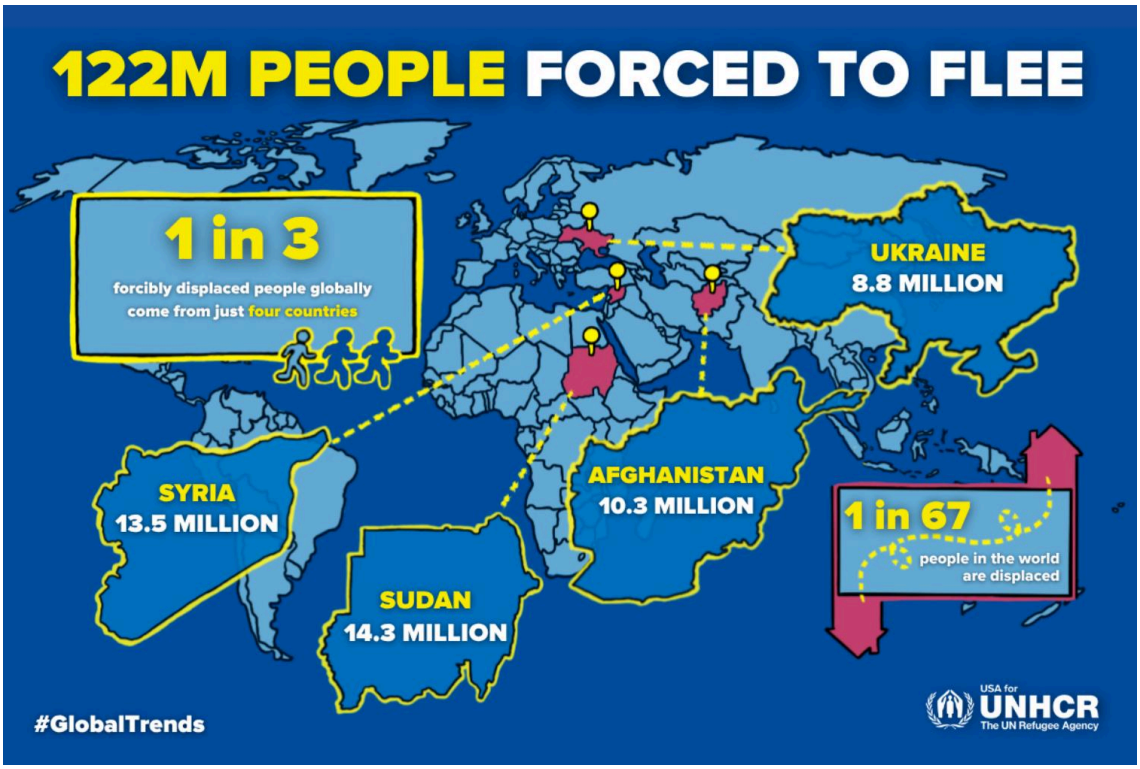
According to UNHCR's Global Trends reports, forced displacement remains at historically unprecedented levels with over 122 million people worldwide displaced due to conflicts, persecution, violences and human rights violations by the middle of 2025. This includes approximately 4.5 million refugees, 8.4 million asylum seekers, and tens of millions of internally displaced persons and others in need of protection. Most refugees continue to remain in countries neighboring their places of origin, with low and middle income states hosting the majority of those in need. Refugees often face significant challenges in accessing basic services, legal protection and durable solutions, while humanitarian resources are stretched thin due to funding shortfalls.



d. Background of the Issue

Large scale movements of refugees and displaced people strain national systems, especially in regions close to active conflicts. Responsibility sharing among states remains uneven and many host countries struggle with limited resources and infrastructure to meet increasing needs. Vulnerable groups such as women, children, and people with disabilities are often disproportionately affected and require targeted protection measures. Despite some successful voluntary returns in 2024 such as to parts of Syria, most displacement situations are protracted,

with few immediate prospects for safe and sustainable solutions. Strengthening international coordination, improving asylum procedures and expanding equitable responsibility sharing are critical to enhancing global refugee protection and reception.



e. Major Parties Involved (As Host Countries)

- ***Türkiye***

The refugee situation in Türkiye is complex due to the large number of people seeking refuge in the country. Since the beginning of the Syrian civil war, Türkiye has received millions of refugees, mainly Syrians, who are fleeing away from conflict and insecurity. In the mid 2020s Türkiye continues to host one of the largest refugee populations worldwide, with several million individuals registered under temporary protection. Refugees in Türkiye require access to basic services such as healthcare, education, housing, and employment. While national institutions and international partners, including UNHCR, are involved in addressing these needs, the long term presence of a large refugee population has placed pressure on public services, local communities, and administrative systems. By 2025, the situation in Türkiye illustrates the ongoing challenges of hosting large refugee populations over extended periods and highlights the need for continued international cooperation, responsibility sharing, and sustainable policy approaches.

- ***Iran***

Iran has hosted large numbers of refugees for many years, particularly people fleeing from conflict and instability in Afghanistan and Iraq. The country accommodates millions of

displaced individuals with several legal statuses, including officially registered refugees as well as undocumented populations. According to UNHCR, refugees in Iran experience ongoing challenges related to legal status, access to services, and long term protection. By 2025, Iran's situation reflects the broader difficulties faced by host countries dealing with prolonged displacement, underlining the importance of international cooperation and shared responsibility.

- ***Pakistan***

Pakistan hosts a significant number of Afghan refugees who have fled over decades of conflict. Refugees in Pakistan encounter challenges related to documentation, healthcare, education and employment opportunities. By 2025, Pakistan remains a key country for refugee protection in South Asia, illustrating both the strain on national resources and the critical role of international support including collaboration with UNHCR.

- ***Sudan***

Sudan is both a source and transit country for displaced populations due to ongoing armed conflicts and internal instability. Many civilians are forced to leave their homes, with some seeking safety in neighboring countries. According to UNHCR, displaced people in Sudan face threats to security, limited access to basic services, and humanitarian challenges. By 2025, Sudan continues to be a significant contributor to regional displacement trends, emphasizing the need for protection and humanitarian intervention.

- ***Germany***

Germany plays a dual role by hosting refugees and providing financial and logistical support internationally. Germany receives refugees from multiple conflict-affected regions while contributing to resettlement programs and humanitarian aid worldwide. By 2025, Germany's involvement demonstrates how donor states can complement host countries in managing displacement, promoting protection and ensuring that international obligations are met.

6. Previous UN Actions and Resolutions

The United Nations has taken many steps to protect refugees and support countries that host them. In 2016, the General Assembly adopted the New York Declaration for Refugees and Migrants, which calls for countries to share responsibility and work together to protect refugees. In 2018, the Global Compact on Refugees was approved to improve international cooperation, provide better protection and promote solutions such as resettlement, local integration or safe return.

The UN General Assembly also passes annual resolutions to review UNHCR reports, encourage protection efforts and remind member states of their responsibilities. Older resolutions like Resolution 45/251 (1990) stressed the importance of following international law and finding long-term solutions for refugees. Other resolutions have called for emergency assistance during crises, making sure refugees receive shelter , food and safety. These actions

form the basis for today's discussions on how to strengthen the protection and reception of refugees worldwide.

7. Roles of the Member States

Member States play different roles in protecting refugees and managing displacement. Countries hosting large numbers of refugees such as Türkiye, Iran, Pakistan, Lebanon and Germany are responsible for providing access to basic services; including shelter, healthcare, education and legal protection. They also coordinate with UNHCR and other international partners to implement humanitarian programs and support integration efforts. Countries of origin including Syria, Afghanistan and Sudan have the responsibility to work toward stability, peace and the protection of human rights to allow refugees to return safely. Donor states such as Germany, Canada and the United States, contribute financial aid, technical support and resettlement opportunities to share the burden with host countries.

All Member States are encouraged to participate in international cooperation, develop fair asylum procedures and support durable solutions for refugees. Their collaboration is essential to ensure that protection standards are met and that the global response to forced displacement is effective and sustainable.

8. Questions a Resolution Paper Must Address

1. What kind of solutions can be found for problems caused by refugees illegal activity in host countries?

2. Does international cooperation play a role in preventing refugee problems?

3. Should UN support host countries who struggle by migration problem?

4. What can be done to improve living conditions for refugees in host countries?

5. How can refugees be given better access to healthcare, education and jobs?

6. What special measures are needed to protect vulnerable groups such as women and children?

7. What role should international organizations particularly UNHCR play in coordinating global refugee responses?

8. What challenges do host countries face when their national systems are overwhelmed by high numbers of refugees and how can these challenges be addressed?

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